



A New Home for Maslan: The Case for a Permanent, Resilient Facility

About Maslan

Maslan – The Negev's Sexual Assault and Domestic Violence Support Center – has served southern Israel for over 37 years, covering 60% of the country's geographic area, from Kiryat Gat to Eilat, including the Gaza Envelope. Its dual mission is to support and empower survivors of sexual assault and domestic violence as they heal, regain agency, and reengage with their communities, and to foster a future free of sexual violence through education, awareness raising, and systemic change.

Maslan helps survivors recover and rebuild their lives through a multi-layered support system. It provides free, confidential, expert care through a 24/7 multilingual crisis helpline and accompaniment throughout medical appointments, police reports, and legal proceedings. Case managers provide holistic care, coordinating between therapy, law enforcement, the prosecutor's office, hospitals, and welfare agencies. Maslan also provides therapy and support groups, some of which include, yoga therapy, bibliotherapy, self-defense, and a domestic violence support group for Russian speakers.

Simultaneously, Maslan addresses the root causes of sexual violence through prevention and awareness initiatives that challenge societal norms and victim-blaming narratives and promote accountability. It provides workshops and training on healthy relationships, consent and boundaries, and recognizing risks within formal and informal education, pre-army courses, workplaces, and more. It provides state-certified training for Designated Safeguarding Leads for the prevention of sexual harassment in the workplace, and its Education Facilitator training course scales prevention efforts and expands awareness and healthy sexuality programming. Maslan holds conferences and training for professionals to recognize and respond to signs of abuse and receive tools to help themselves cope with secondary trauma. It also partners with law enforcement to promote and ensure more empathetic and effective responses to survivors.

Maslan serves the diverse populations of the Negev region, including Arab and Bedouin communities, religious and secular Jews, immigrants from the former Soviet Union and Ethiopia, LGBTQ+ individuals, and people with disabilities. It provides emergency support for survivors 18+ and family members and reaches all ages through its education programs.

Maslan's Current Needs

According to the Ministry of Public Security, 1 in 3 women and 1 in 5 children under 14 will experience sexual assault in their lifetimes. The atrocities of October 7th and the Swords of Iron war intensified this crisis. Media coverage triggered pre-existing trauma and exacerbated mental health concerns for survivors of sexual assault and domestic violence. Evacuation conditions and reserve duty increased exposure to violence, and the region saw a sharp rise in PTSD, anxiety, depression, eating disorders, and suicidal ideation. This acute mental health crisis is compounded by a deeply entrenched societal challenge: sexual violence often remains silenced or dismissed due to patriarchal power structures that shift blame onto survivors, leaving many to suffer in isolation without the support they need to heal. As the nearest rape crisis center to the Gaza envelope, Maslan has been at the forefront of this crisis. Research indicates that as conditions stabilize after war, more survivors begin reporting their experiences; therefore, Maslan anticipates a significant rise in the upcoming years.

Over the past two years, Maslan has significantly expanded its reach and programming across the Negev to meet these growing needs, including:

- Increased services for communities affected by October 7th and the ongoing operations, especially in the Western Negev (Sderot, Netivot, Ofakim)
- Expanded support for the families of reserve soldiers, with a focus on intimate partner violence prevention





- Deepened engagement within Negev Bedouin communities, in both support services and prevention workshops
- Provided support services for evacuees and survivors triggered by October 7th
- Increased prevention and awareness workshops and training addressing the rising violence within workplaces, schools, and online environments
- Increased training courses to bolster Maslan's staff and programming including: A Designated Safeguarding Leads course, a Prevention Education Facilitator course, and a Volunteers course
- Developed a Help the Helpers program to provide its team with supervision, continued education and tools to prevent secondary trauma and burnout

As Maslan's activities have significantly grown this past year, it has identified the need for a larger, more accessible facility to better serve the breadth of its work across the Negev. Additionally, the temporary closures of Maslan's physical center during Operation Rising Lion (June 2025) and Operation Roaring Lion (March 2026) made the need for a protected shelter undeniable. For survivors of sexual assault and domestic violence, a gap in services during periods of crisis is not a minor inconvenience, it is a serious risk. Maslan's building must have a protected shelter in order to provide continuous critical support services.

Maslan's current building presents several structural limitations that prevent the organization from operating at the scale and accessibility its mission demands:

- **No protected shelter** - Any future security escalation will again require the mandatory closure of the physical center, interrupting the continuity of care.
- **Remote location** - Maslan's building is situated in a remote neighborhood of Beer Sheva with limited access to public transportation. As an organization serving the entire Negev, from Kiryat Gat to Eilat, including the Gaza Envelope, this presents a significant barrier for many beneficiaries.
- **Insufficient space** - The building contains a single large room for group activities, creating persistent scheduling conflicts between therapeutic groups, volunteer training, education programs, and staff meetings. The space does not meet the operational needs of the organization.

The Vision

Maslan is actively searching for a new facility, one that includes a protected shelter, is accessible by public transportation, is situated in a central and reachable location, and is large enough to accommodate the full scope of Maslan's programming and organizational needs.

Maslan's donors and partners have long made it possible for the organization to stand by the most vulnerable women in the Negev. Securing a new building is the next essential step in ensuring that Maslan can continue to do so, not only under ordinary circumstances, but during emergencies, conflicts, and crises, when the need for its services is greatest.

Support for this initiative is an investment in Maslan's long-term resilience and in the safety and wellbeing of the thousands of the women and families it serves across the region. Maslan welcomes the opportunity to discuss this project and explore partnership possibilities with those who share its commitment to this mission.

Help us build a home that survivors in the Negev can always count on

